



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brilla Pax Elementary

School Website: <https://brillaschools.org/our-schools/brilla-pax/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Brilla Pax Elementary Ny 10468 shows partial alignment with classical education through its emphasis on virtue and character development, but its public materials do not consistently demonstrate foundational classical elements such as explicit Great Books study, the Trivium (grammar–logic–rhetoric), Socratic pedagogy, or a historically grounded curriculum. Public content highlights a virtue-centered, college-ready mission and a welcoming, open-community stance, yet it lacks explicit attestations to key classical practices (Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, memorization/narration at scale, liturgical or contemplative practices, and a formalized living curriculum). Therefore, the overall assessment leans toward NOT CLASSICAL, with several category-specific signals of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (notably in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Parents & Community) but insufficient breadth and depth to achieve CLASSICAL status across the six categories.

Key takeaways - The school's public materials foreground virtue-centered education and college-readiness, and they emphasize openness to families and community engagement. This aligns with some classical aims in spirit (formation of character, community involvement) but stops short of many canonical classical markers (Great Books, Trivium pedagogy, Great Conversation, formal sacred/traditional liturgy, etc.). Evidence includes statements about serving families with an academically rigorous, virtue-centered education and enrollment openness (no entrance exams) within a multi-school Brilla network.

- Category-by-category signals: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (virtue-focused language; no explicit theology or liturgical practices). - School Purpose and Goal: NOT CLASSICAL (focus on college readiness with virtue framing; limited explicit formation/true-paideia framing).
- Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL (no clear Great Books, Latin/Greek, or explicit liberal-arts curriculum in public materials). - Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL (no explicit Socratic/seminar/rhetoric-focused pedagogy documented in public materials). - Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (public materials list qualified staff but do not present a "living curriculum" or classical faculty portrait; emphasis is on personnel rather than classical formation). - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (open enrollment, transparent access, and invitation to visit; limited explicit parent-formation or co-teaching language).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize virtue-centered education, focusing on character and formation rather than explicit religious/theological instruction or liturgical practices. Example language: "academically rigorous and virtue-centered education" and a mission to develop students' hearts and minds.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: virtue (1).
 - Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials for this category.
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 1 vs. Negative 0 (effectively 100% positive among observed religious/metaphysical cues, but the set of required indicators is broader than what is evidenced).

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- Why this rating
 - While virtue-based language appears, there is no explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgy, or communal worship practices documented in public content. The absence of these core signals precludes CLASSICAL under the rubric, though the virtue emphasis nudges the category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school states an aim to provide an academically rigorous and virtue-centered education designed to “succeed in college and beyond,” signaling preparation for accolades and outcomes rather than a paideia-oriented formation focused on virtue and wisdom as telos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: virtue (1) and college/beyond framing (1).
 - Negative keywords present: none explicit in the public materials for this category (no clear references to “formation over information” or “paideia” language in the site copy).
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 1–2; Negative 0 (roughly 100% of observed signals are positive in terms of virtue/college-outcome language, but not aligned with the deeper formation emphasis).
- Why this rating
 - The explicit emphasis on college readiness and outcomes, without a stated aim of education for true human excellence, formation, or contemplation, signals a misalignment with classical telos-focused aims. Thus NOT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL, with some formation signals via virtue.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public content highlights an academically rigorous and virtue-centered program but does not document liberal-arts curriculum elements like grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or a sustained Great Conversation approach. The site copy does not reference a classical curriculum framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: none clearly identified (no “grammar,” “logic,” “rhetoric,” “Great Books,” “Latin/Greek,” or “history as Western civilization” signals in the public copy).
 - Negative keywords present: absence of Great Books/Trivium signals; not explicitly stated as “social studies” or “project-based STEM-first” signals either, but the absence itself is informative.
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 0; Negative 0 (no classical curriculum indicators observed).
- Why this rating
 - Absent are core classical curriculum markers (the Trivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and a historically grounded history sequence). Without these signals, the curriculum dimension does not meet classical criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - There is no explicit documentation of Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or deliberate formation through imitation and practice in the public content. The staff pages focus on roles and biographies rather than pedagogical methodology.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: none clearly detectable in public copy for pedagogy (no explicit reference to Socratic dialogues, chanting, or memory work).
 - Negative keywords present: none explicitly stated; however, the absence of classical pedagogical signals is itself a negative signal.
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 0; Negative 0 (no explicit pedagogy indicators observed).

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- Why this rating
 - The lack of documented classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion, Scholé, memorization and recitation, etc.) places this category outside classical alignment.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site features staff bios and roles (e.g., Third Grade Teacher and Team Lead, Operations Coordinator) that signal a professional faculty but do not present a “living curriculum,” portrait of teacher ideals, or a classical mentorship model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: teacher as part of a team, professional development language is visible, but not explicit classical vocabulary like “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as mentors.”
 - Negative keywords present: none explicitly negative, but absence of classical faculty alignment signals.
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 0–1; Negative 0.
- Why this rating
 - The lack of explicit classical-faculty descriptors (living curriculum, portrait, mentorship culture) supports NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Brilla Pax site communicates openness to families and community engagement (enrollment is free and no entrance exam; they invite visits; public description emphasizes serving families in the Bronx). This indicates a willingness to partner with families and be an accessible community hub, which aligns somewhat with classical emphasis on parental partnership and community formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families/co-teachers language is not explicitly stated, but openness and family engagement are implied through accessible enrollment and invitations to visit; “serve the families” language is present.
 - Negative keywords present: explicit parent-formation, book clubs, family liturgy, or other formal parental education signals are not observed.
 - Frequency estimate: Positive 1; Negative 0 (partial alignment with classical community formation).
- Why this rating
 - The school’s public materials show openness to families and community engagement, a hallmark of classical education’s community dimension, but lack explicit commitments to parent formation or joint-educator partnerships. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Across the six categories, Brilla Pax Elementary Ny 10468 demonstrates a few classical signals (notably virtue-centered orientation and open, welcoming community posture) but lacks core classical curriculum, pedagogy, and theology/liturgical foundations in publicly accessible materials. The category-by-category mix yields a general assessment of NOT CLASSICAL, with notable SOMEWHAT signals in Element 1 and Element 6.

What would move the needle

- Adopt explicit Great Books/Great Conversation principles across the curriculum, paired with a Trivium framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric) and a Latin/Greek component for appropriate grade bands.
- Implement documented classical pedagogy, including Socratic seminars in upper grades, structured narrations/recitations, and a restful-Scholé cadence (integrating contemplation with rigorous study).

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- Develop a documented “living curriculum” with portraits of teacher-student formation standards, and a formal faculty development path aligned with classical pedagogy.
 - Create explicit parent formation and partnership programs (parent book studies, classical home education guidance, family liturgy/rituals) and clearly state them on the website to foreground the parental co-educator role.
 - Normalize liturgical or communal practices (where appropriate to the school’s mission) to reflect a more intentional religious/metaphysical dimension that aligns with classical patterns (without compromising inclusivity or the school’s charter).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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